European Commission

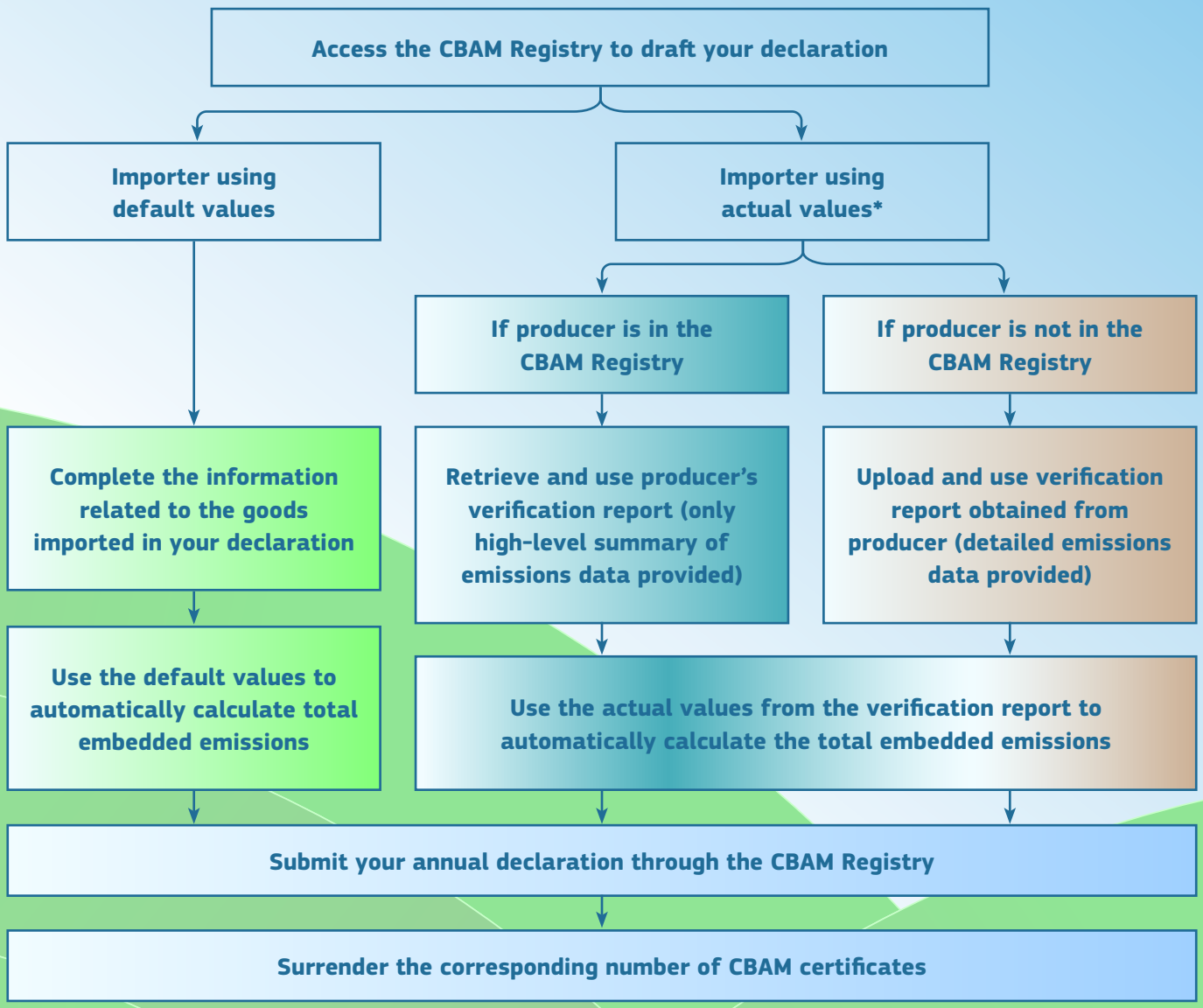
#CBAM

CARBON BORDER ADJUSTMENT MECHANISM: ACTUAL VS DEFAULT VALUES IN YOUR DECLARATION

CBAM requires EU importers of certain goods to become authorised CBAM declarants, report the embedded carbon emissions in these goods, and meet related financial obligations. By **30 September 2027**, importers of CBAM goods **must submit their first CBAM declaration** - covering embedded emissions from 2026 imports - **and surrender the corresponding CBAM certificates**.

Importers can report emissions using **default values** provided by the Commission or **actual values**. If an importer chooses to report actual values, the producer in the third country must provide **verified emissions data on the total embedded emissions**.

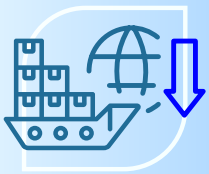
The decision tree below can help importers follow the correct steps.



**Only possible if the producer in a third country monitors, calculates, and verifies embedded emissions and shares the relevant information.*

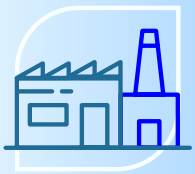
PREPARE FOR ACTUAL VERIFIED CBAM EMISSIONS

Join the CBAM Registry.



EU importers

Work with your third country producers to obtain reliable emissions data for imported goods. If actual values are used, these must be supported by a verification report on embedded emissions.



Producers in a third country

Monitor your CBAM emissions and verify your calculations with an accredited CBAM verifier.



Verifiers

Contact **EU-based National Accreditation Bodies (NABs)** to apply for CBAM accreditation. Once accredited, you can verify embedded emissions and issue verification reports directly in the CBAM Registry.

For more CBAM resources, visit the CBAM Communication and FAQs page.

© European Union, 2026

Catalogue number: KP-01-26-017-EN-N – ISBN: 978-92-68-39346-8 – doi:10.2778/2605039